MIL-L-44190
27 June 1985
SUPERSEDING
(See 6.3)

MILITARY SPECIFICATION

LOBSTER TAIL, SPINY, RAW, FROZEN

This specification is approved for use by all Departments and Agencies of the Department of Defense.

1. SCOPE

1.1 Scope. This document covers raw frozen spiny lobster tails for use by the Department of Defense.

2. APPLICABLE DOCUMENTS

2.1 Government documents. Unless otherwise specified, the following documents of the issue in effect on date of invitation for bids or request for proposal, form a part of this document to the extent specified herein.

Beneficial comments (recommendations, additions, deletions) and any pertinent data which may be of use in improving this document should be addressed to: U.S. Army Natick Research and Development Center, Natick, MA 01760-5014 by using the self-addressed Standardization Document Improvement Proposal (DD Form 1426) appearing at the end of this document or by letter.

FSC 8905

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SPECIFICATIONS

FEDERAL

PPP-B-636 - Boxes, Shipping, Fiberboard
PPP-B-1163 - Box, Corrugated Fiberboard, High Compression Strength, Weather-Resistant, Wax-Resin Impregnated

STANDARDS

MILITARY

MIL-STD-105 - Sampling Procedures and Tables for Inspection by Attributes
MIL-STD-129 - Marking for Shipment and Storage

(Copies of documents required by manufacturers in connection with specific acquisition functions should be obtained from the contracting activity or as directed by the contracting officer.)

OTHER GOVERNMENT DOCUMENTS

Laws and Regulations

U.S. DEPARTMENT OF HEALTH AND HUMAN SERVICES

Federal Food, Drug, and Cosmetic Act and Regulations Promulgated Thereunder (21 CFR Parts 1 - 199)

(Application for copies should be addressed to the Superintendent of Documents, U.S. Government Printing Office, Washington, DC 20402.)

ENVIRONMENTAL PROTECTION AGENCY (EPA)

National Interim Primary Drinking Water Regulations

(Application for copies should be addressed to the Office of Drinking Water WH550, Environmental Protection Agency, Washington, DC 20460.)

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U.S. DEPARTMENT OF COMMERCE

Regulations Governing Processed Fishery Products and U.S. Standards for Grades of Fishery Products (20 CFR Part 260)

(Application for copies should be addressed to the National Oceanic and Atmospheric Administration, National Marine Fisheries Service, Page Building No. 2, Room 300, 300 Whithaven Street, N.W., Washington, DC 20235.)

2.2 Other publications. Unless otherwise specified, the following documents of the issue in effect on date of invitation for bids or request for proposal, form a part of this document to the extent specified herein.

NATIONAL MOTOR FREIGHT TRAFFIC ASSOCIATION, INC., AGENT

National Motor Freight Classification

(Application for copies should be addressed to the American Trucking Associations, Inc., Traffic Department, 1616 P Street, N.W., Washington, DC 20036.)

UNIFORM CLASSIFICATION COMMITTEE, AGENT

Uniform Freight Classification

(Application for copies should be addressed to the Uniform Classification Committee, Suite 1106, 222 South Riverside Plaza, Chicago, IL 60606.)

(Technical society and technical association documents are generally available for reference from libraries. They are also distributed among technical groups and using Federal agencies.)

2.3 Order of precedence. In the event of a conflict between the text of this document and the references cited herein, the text of this document shall take precedence.

3. REQUIREMENTS

3.1 Ingredients. All ingredients shall be clean, sound, wholesome and free from foreign materials, off-odors, off-flavors and off-colors.

3.1.1 Spiny lobster tail. The spiny lobster tails shall be from spiny lobsters of the Family Palinuridae, Genus Panulirus, species a) argus, or b) interruptus.

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3.1.2 Water. Water used for washing shall conform to the National Interim Primary Drinking Water Regulations.

3.2 Preparation and processing.

3.2.1 Spiny lobster tails processing. The spiny lobster tails shall be handled and processed in accordance with Part 260, of the Code of Federal Regulations, Title 50, Chapter II. The spiny lobster tails shall be processed from fresh, raw, unfrozen spiny lobsters and shall be individually placed in polyethylene bags (see 5.1), placed in a freezer maintained at 0°F or less within 2 hours of packaging, and frozen to an internal temperature of 0°F or less within 24 hours.

3.3 Finished product. The finished product shall comply with the following requirements:

a. There shall be no foreign material, such as but not limited to glass, dirt, hair, wood, or metal.

b. There shall be no foreign odors such as, but not limited to putrid or spoiled.

c. There shall be no color foreign to the product.

d. There shall be no evidence of dehydration.

e. The product shall be free of shell fragments, viscera, and intestinal tract contents.

f. The product shall not have soft shell.

g. Flesh shall be transulcent, not opaque.

h. There shall be no evidence of tail damage (cuts or scars penetrating the shell or crushed shell).

i. There shall be no evidence of thawing, refreezing, or glazing.

j. Each spiny lobster tail shall weigh not less than 5.0 ounces and not greater than 10.0 ounces (individual tails shall not be split to meet this requirement).

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3.4 Plant qualification. The product shall be prepared, processed, and packaged in accordance with Part 260, Chapter II, Title 50 of the Code of Federal Regulations.

3.5 Federal Food, Drug, and Cosmetic Act. All deliveries shall conform in every respect to the provisions of the Federal Food, Drug, and Cosmetic Act and regulations promulgated thereunder.

4. QUALITY ASSURANCE PROVISIONS

4.1 Contractor's responsibility. Inspection and acceptance by the USDC shall not relieve the contractor of obligation and responsibility to deliver a product complying with all the requirements of this document. The contractor shall assure product compliance prior to submitting the product to the USDC for any inspection.

4.2 Inspection and certification. Product acceptability shall be determined by the USDC. The USDC will determine the degree of supervision necessary to assure compliance with the requirements of this document.

4.3 Quality conformance inspection procedure. Unless otherwise specified, sampling for inspection shall be performed in accordance with MIL-STD-105.

4.3.1 Ingredient and component examination. Conformance of ingredients and components to identity, condition, and other requirements shall be determined by examination of pertinent labels, markings, U.S. Grade certificates, invoices, certificates of analysis, or other valid documents. In addition, each ingredient shall be examined organoleptically as necessary to determine conformance to the condition requirements. Any nonconformance to an identity, condition, or other requirement shall be cause for rejection of the ingredient lot or of any involved product.

4.3.1.1 Examination of finished product. The finished product shall be examined for the defects listed in table I. The lot size shall be expressed in pounds. The sample unit shall be one frozen spiny lobster tail. The inspection level shall be S-3, and the acceptable quality level (AQL), expressed in terms of defects per hundred units, shall be 1.5 for major defects and 4.0 for minor defects.

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TABLE I. Product defects 1/ 2/ 3/

Category		Defect
Major	Minor	
101		Net weight of whole tail less than 5.0 ounces or more than 10.0 ounces.
102		Product temperature greater than 0°F.
103		Evidence of dehydration.
	201	Presence of shell fragments.
	202	Presence of viscera.
104		Presence of intestinal tract contents.
105		Soft shell.
106		Opaque flesh.
107		Damaged tail (cuts or scars penetrating the shell).
108		Crushed shell.
109		Not packaged as specified.

1/ The finding of incorrect species shall be cause for rejection of the lot.

2/ Acceptability of product with respect to presence of foreign material (such as but not limited to glass, dirt, hair, wood, or metal) shall be made by a USDC employee.

3/ Evidence of thawing, refreezing, glazing or presence of any off-condition such as but not limited to being of abnormal color, being gassy, rancid, sour, or having off-odors shall be cause for rejection of the lot.

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4.3.1.2 Shipping container examination. Shipping containers shall be examined for defects in construction, packing, closure, and reinforcement in accordance with the appendix of PPP-B-636 or PPP-B-1163, as applicable, except that the following additional defects shall apply:

Major

National stock number, item description, contract number, or date of pack markings missing, incorrect, or illegible.
Not snug-fitting or evidence of bulging.
Net weight less than marked on container.
Reinforcement with nonmetallic strapping or tape not used.

Minor

Weight of contents exceed 50 pounds.
Not closed as specified.
Other marking requirements not as specified.

Level C shipping containers shall be examined for the marking and weight defects specified above.

5. PACKAGING

5.1 Preservation. Preservation shall be level B or C.

5.1.1 Level B. Each lobster tail shall be placed in a polyethylene bag that is 0.004 inch (nominal) or thicker. The bag shall be closed by heat sealing. The bagged lobster tails shall then be frozen (see 3.2.1) and packed in an intermediate container in accordance with good commercial practice. Glazing shall be prohibited.

5.1.2 Level C. Each lobster tail shall be placed in a polyethylene bag and the bag closed by folding it over. The bagged lobster tails shall then be frozen (see 3.2.1) and packed in an intermediate container in accordance with good commercial practice. Glazing shall be prohibited.

5.2 Packing. The product shall be packed in accordance with level B or C, as specified (see 6.1).

5.2.1 Level B packing. Not more than 50 pounds of the product preserved as specified in 5.1 shall be packed in a snug-fitting fiberboard box made in

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accordance with requirements for V3c, V3s, or V4s, style RSC, of PPP-B-636. The container shall be strapped with nonmetallic strapping or pressure-sensitive adhesive filament reinforced tape in accordance with PPP-B-636 except that two straps shall be applied. One strap shall be applied girthwise and one lengthwise. Alternatively, the shipping container shall be a wax-impregnated fiberboard box constructed in accordance with style RSC, class I, SWCFI, grade 275, of PPP-B-1163. Closure shall be with hot-melt adhesive in accordance with the appendix of PPP-B-636. The shipping container shall be reinforced with two lengthwise bands and one girthwise band in accordance with the appendix of PPP-B-636. The strapping shall be limited to nonmetallic strapping or pressure-sensitive adhesive filament reinforced tape.

5.2.2 Level C packing. Not more than 50 pounds of the product preserved as specified in 5.1 shall be packed in a shipping container in accordance with National Motor Freight Classification or Uniform Freight Classification, as applicable.

5.3 Labeling and marking.

5.3.1 Labeling. Any commercial labeling, or additional labeling as specified, that complies with Federal Food, Drug, and Cosmetic Act and regulations promulgated thereunder, is acceptable.

5.3.2 Marking of shipping containers. Shipping containers shall be marked in accordance with MIL-STD-129 and in addition the following markings shall appear on the top of the shipping containers in letters between 1 and 1-1/2 inches high, all letters being the same height:

KEEP FROZEN (0°F OR BELOW)

6. NOTES

6.1 Ordering data. Purchasers should exercise any desired options offered herein and acquisition documents should specify the following:

a. Weight of spiny lobster tails (5-6 oz./tail, 6-8 oz./tail, or 8-10 oz./tail).
b. Level of packaging and packing required (see 5.1 and 5.2).

6.2 Contractor's inspection. The contractor should be required to assure that the product conforms with this document prior to submission to the Government for final inspection.

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6.3 Supersession data. This document includes the requirements of Purchase Description PD 367A, Spiny Lobster Tail, Frozen, dated 18 November 1982.

Custodians:

Army - GL
Navy - SA
Air Force - 50

Preparing activity:

Army - GL

Project No. 8905-B012

Review activities:

Army - MD, TS
Navy - MC, MS
DP - SS

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NOTE: This form may not be used to request copies of documents, nor to request waivers, deviations, or clarification of specification requirements on current contracts. Comments submitted on this form do not constitute or imply authorization to waive any portion of the referenced document*(s)* or to amend contractual requirements.

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STANDARDIZATION DOCUMENT IMPROVEMENT PROPOSAL

(See Instructions – Reverse Side)

1. DOCUMENT NUMBER	2. DOCUMENT TITLE
MIL-L-44190	Lobster Tail, Spiny, Raw, Frozen

3a. NAME OF SUBMITTING ORGANIZATION	4. TYPE OF ORGANIZATION *(Mark one)*
	☐ VENDOR ☐ USER ☐ MANUFACTURER ☐ OTHER *(Specify)*: _____
b. ADDRESS *(Street, City, State, ZIP Code)*	

5. PROBLEM AREAS

a. Paragraph Number and Wording:

b. Recommended Wording:

c. Reason/Rationale for Recommendation:

6. REMARKS

7a. NAME OF SUBMITTER *(Last, First, MI)* – Optional	b. WORK TELEPHONE NUMBER *(Include Area Code)* – Optional
c. MAILING ADDRESS *(Street, City, State, ZIP Code)* – Optional	8. DATE OF SUBMISSION *(YYMMDD)*

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NATICK/OP, 20 Nov 84

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